CRISTINA GONZALEZ

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Hi, I'm Cristina, a senior operator who builds the engine behind ambitious startups. I believe in the magic of small teams, that lightning in a bottle moment when the right people are building something together, and my work is making that lightning last. I design the systems a company runs on, from investor relations and hiring to operating rhythms, forecasting, and the offsites that turn a group of people into a team, using AI, technology, and creativity to solve problems fast and build things that scale. (Also: I always have candy.)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SENIOR DIRECTOR, OPERATIONS | SUNDOGS | 2024 – 2026, Fast Company Most Innovative Companies 2026

Pre-seed AI startup in creative tech; founding ops hire partnering with COO to build and scale infrastructure

- Company Infrastructure: Built the operations that supported growth from $0 to $6M+ in revenue, including SOPs, knowledge hubs, client delivery pipelines, reporting, and foundational SOC 2 policies and controls.
- Strategy & Operating Rhythm: Established company KPIs, quarterly goals, and weekly operating reviews covering pipeline, delivery, utilization, hiring, and risk; translated priorities into owners, milestones, and follow through.
- Finance, Revenue & Investor Relations: Built FP&A models and pricing frameworks and owned budgeting and forecasting; designed CRM and pipeline workflows in Monday; built investor data rooms, prepared investor materials, and coordinated investor communications.
- People Operations: Designed the hiring system from job descriptions and scorecards through offers, negotiation, and onboarding, hiring five employees; selected and managed Gusto and Rippling; established performance review and feedback cycles for a 10 person distributed team.
- AI & Automation: Built AI tools for the operating rhythm: a weekly KPI briefing that turned dashboard data into a narrative on what moved, why, and what needed a decision; and a meeting tracker that pulled action items and owners from leadership syncs into a weekly Slack digest.
- Culture & Leadership Support: Designed and facilitated quarterly company offsites, from agenda and programming through travel and logistics; managed confidential personnel and equity matters for leadership.

SENIOR DIRECTOR | WORKMONEY | 2022 – 2024

Civic tech and advocacy startup with a national membership of 9M+

- Editorial Operating Model: Replaced an ad hoc process of Slack ideas and shared drafts with a two track publishing model, one for scheduled partnership communications and one for policy and breaking news, each with its own process for ideation, editing, and feedback.
- Production & Testing Pipeline: Designed the templates, workflows, KPIs, and meeting cadences that moved messages from pitch through editing, audience targeting, data review, and testing.
- Team Leadership: Hired, managed, and developed a team of five across writing, design, production, and analysis, setting priorities and building shared workflows. All five remain with the organization.
- Organizational Impact: Led the team responsible for testing and delivering every member communication, the channel every department relied on to reach 9M+ members, including during the midterms.

EDITOR & OPERATIONS LEAD | WAITWHAT | 2017 – 2022

Media & tech start up; scaled Masters of Scale with Reid Hoffman

- Flagship Show: Joined at launch and shaped Masters of Scale from its first episode through four seasons, across editorial development, research, narrative structure, scriptwriting, and production.
- Podcast Portfolio: Built the templates and workflows that made production repeatable across shows, carrying the launch of four additional podcasts.
- Franchise Expansion: Extended Masters of Scale into the Rapid Response spinoff, live events, a book, and an app; developed event programming and run of show, conducted research and early development for the book, and managed the app project and its content.
- Creative & Commercial Development: Shaped creative concepts for brand partnership proposals that became signed advertising deals.

EDUCATION: MA, Journalism; New York University | BA, Journalism; University of Florida